

4.5 Night Photography

There's something about night photography that captivates us. There's a mystical feel that a photographer gets when shooting after dark. The shadows and the selective lighting give your creativity the outlet it was seeking. Alas, what you see with your eyes is never what you capture with your camera. And the solution? Turn off that flash!

Keep It Stable

Do your pictures look like you shot them while travelling on a bullock-cart on some of the worst roads in



Shooting at night requires your hands to be steadier than usual, since you require longer exposure

your city? Were you actually trying as hard as possible to remain motionless when clicking? Chances are, you've been cursed with the worst possible combination in photography—a digital camera and shaky hands. This problem is only made worse at night, and if you want to be able to shoot better photographs, get a tripod or place your camera on a sturdy, stationary surface when clicking. You can also use the self-timer function on your camera to completely avoid blurry images—position the shot, set the timer and gently click, so that when the camera actually clicks the photograph, you are not touching it, causing it to shake.

Higher Exposure

If you're shooting at night, chances are that you want every hint of available light captured. For example, when shooting a cityscape from the top of the building, you would want to



TIP

When you're figuring out the budget for your next digital camera, make sure you factor in the purchase of an additional memory card. Why? Because the included cards are about as satisfying as an airline bag of peanuts when you're dying of hunger. If you have a two megapixel camera, get at least a 64 MB card, 128 MBs for three megapixel models, 256 MBs for four megapixels, and 512 MBs for five megapixels and up.